service chiefs, himself, vice president and the prime minister. One factor in Sattar's capitulation was the food shortage. Many countries, including India, offered, at this time, to rush rice to the country, where prices were skyrocketing.

Indian intelligence officials believed that the emergence of Ershad in Bangladesh was mainly due to three parallel problems —dissension within the ruling party, dissension within the Awami League after the return of Sheikh Hasina from abroad and the return of Khon-daker Mostaq Ahmad to the political arena. They also believed that the developments leading to the coup against Sattar's regime had been complicated. They argued that three aspects were relevant—Bangladesh Prime Minister Rahman's close links with the army, a group of army officers visiting Indonesia just weeks before the coup to study the use of an army in national reconstruction and the army takeover preceded by the resignation of Vice President Huda who was unhappy about his position. The R&AW's analysis shed light on Ershad, who had effectively orchestrated the coup:

Ershad's behaviour during the period leading to the coup has been fairly straightforward. His great political achievement has been to shed the image of a pure expatriate. He has made it a deliberate policy during the recent months to champion the cause of the freedom fighters within the army. This will widen his base, while at the same time, he would retain the loyalty of the large part of the army, which has a continuous professional record from 1971 within the Pakistan army. It is not clear whether the target of this action is the Awami League, Sheikh Hasina and Kamal Hossain, personally. If Er-shad and his colleagues have a certain coherent philosophy of participation in or guidance of political activity of the army, we might see a brief period when all political activity is banned as in Pakistan,